Local Development Portal

Taking it to the next level: ideas and mockups for discussion

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October 2026 · Draft for stakeholder discussion

The point

The portal we prototyped is a solid management system: profiles, priorities, approvals, complaints, partners, all in one place. That is the floor, not the ceiling. The ideas in this document take the portal out of the office and into the village, tie the social process to the money, and let the data work for the people who feed it. Together they make a credible case for an innovation award; individually each one solves a problem the team has today.

The bet in one line
Every franc traceable to a village voice. A villager can see the status of their priority and their worksite, confirms milestones before money moves, and can complain by voice in their own language. Everything else in this document supports that loop or makes it cheaper to run.

Seven ideas at a glance

#	Idea	What changes	Effort	Impact
1	The village sees what the UCP sees	Public status page per worksite, QR code on the signboard	Low	High
2	No smartphone needed	Follow priorities and complain via *123# and voice, in Moba, Kabye, Tem	Medium	High
3	The community signs off before money moves	CVD confirms each milestone with geotagged photo; disbursement follows	Medium	Very high
4	Complaints by voice, triaged in minutes	Voice recordings transcribed, translated and pre-sorted; human validates	Medium	High
5	Every quote checked against what we paid	Line items compared with real regional unit costs; outliers flagged	Low	High
6	Vulnerability that updates itself	Index refreshed quarterly from field, satellite, security and SMS pulse data	High	Medium
7	Partner positions pulled, not typed	Partners' public project data imported and matched to cantons	Low	Medium

1. The village sees what the UCP sees

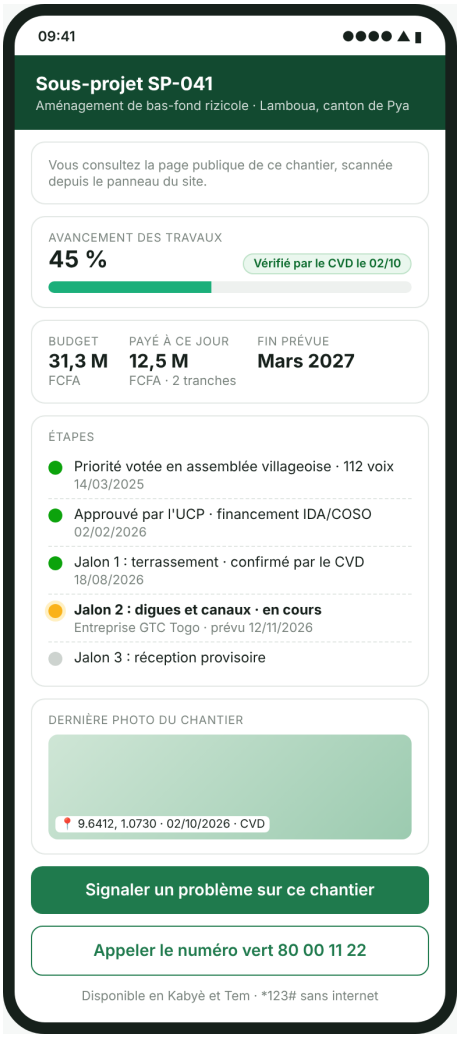
Today. The portal shows progress, budget and payments to staff and partners. The village that voted for the priority sees a signboard with a title and a budget, and then waits.

The idea. Every sub-project gets a public page: progress as confirmed by the village committee, money paid so far, next milestone, the latest site photo, and one button to report a problem. The QR code on the physical signboard opens it. No login.

What it changes. Accountability flows downwards. The contractor knows the village is watching. The UCP stops answering "where is our project" by phone.

What it takes. Mostly data we already have. Signboards need reprinting with a QR code. A decision from UCP that payment figures can be public per worksite.

Risk. Public pages expose delays. That is the point, but it must be agreed, not discovered.





The worksite signboard, redesigned: same legal content, plus a QR code, the toll-free number and the *123# code.

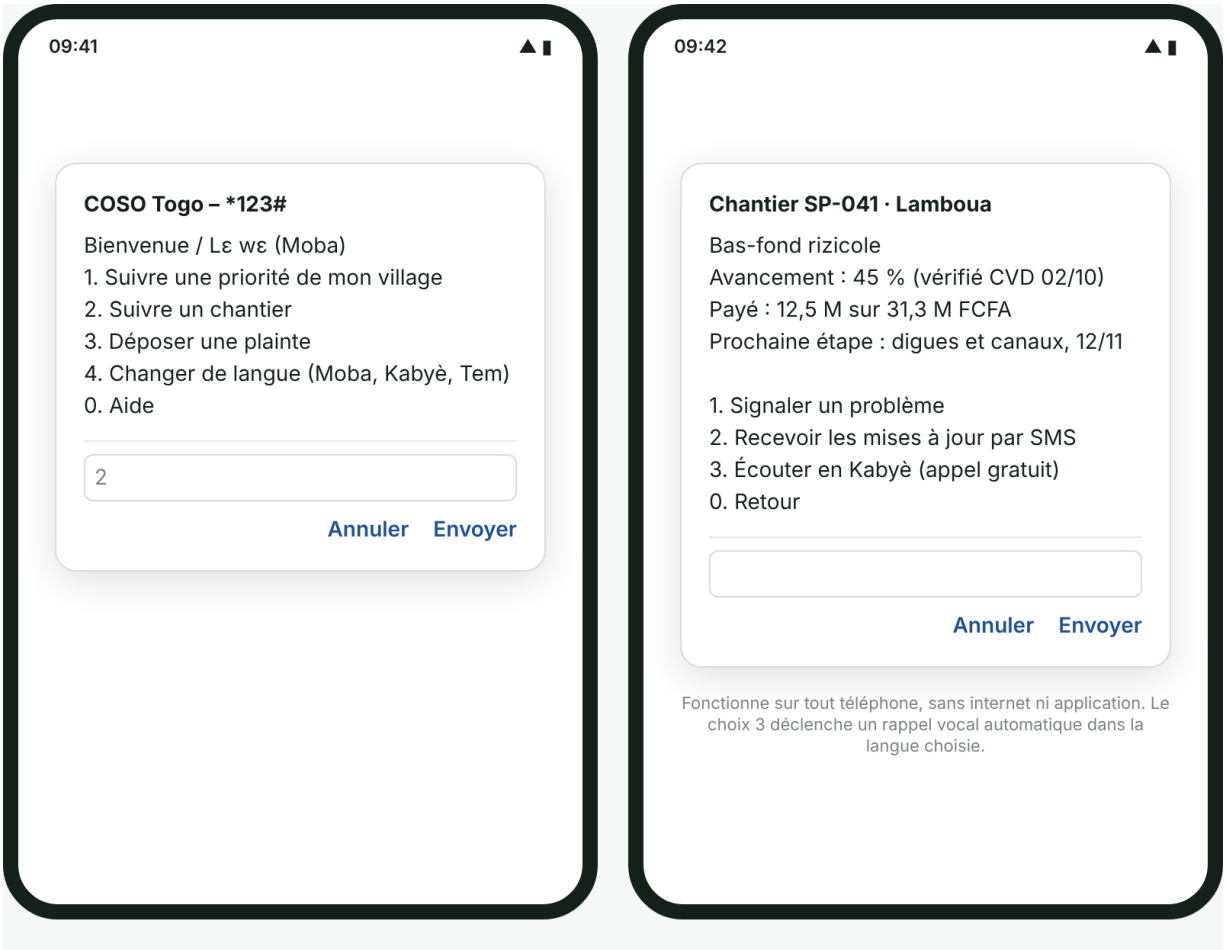
2. No smartphone needed

Today. Information reaches villagers through meetings and whoever has a smartphone. Most phones in the three regions are basic phones. Several languages are spoken; French is not the first one.

The idea. A short code, *123#, that works on any phone without internet: follow my village's priorities, follow a worksite, lodge a complaint, choose my language. Option to receive updates by SMS, or to get an automatic call-back that reads the status aloud in Moba, Kabye or Tem.

What it changes. Reach goes from the connected few to anyone with a phone. The grievance channel becomes genuinely low-barrier, including for women who are less likely to own a smartphone.

What it takes. An agreement with the mobile operators for the short code and the toll-free line; recorded voice prompts in three languages; the portal data already exists.



Left: the *123# menu. Right: the status of a worksite, with the option to be called back in Kabye.

3. The community signs off before money moves

Today. Contractors are paid on the basis of site reports by the supervising engineer. The village committee is informed, sometimes.

The idea. Each sub-project has three or four milestones. For each one, the field agent and the village committee confirm completion from the mobile app: a geotagged, time-stamped photo, a short checklist, and the signatures of the committee president, secretary and women's representative. Only then is the payment tranche released to the UCP for processing. A refusal opens a grievance automatically. Works offline and syncs later.

What it changes. The social process and the financial process become one process. Payment delays become measurable. Ghost progress becomes very hard.

What it takes. A rule change in the disbursement procedure, agreed with the financial management team. The app itself is a modest addition to the field tools.

Risk. Committees could be pressured to sign. Mitigation: the women's representative signature is mandatory, and any signature can be withdrawn through the grievance channel within 10 days.



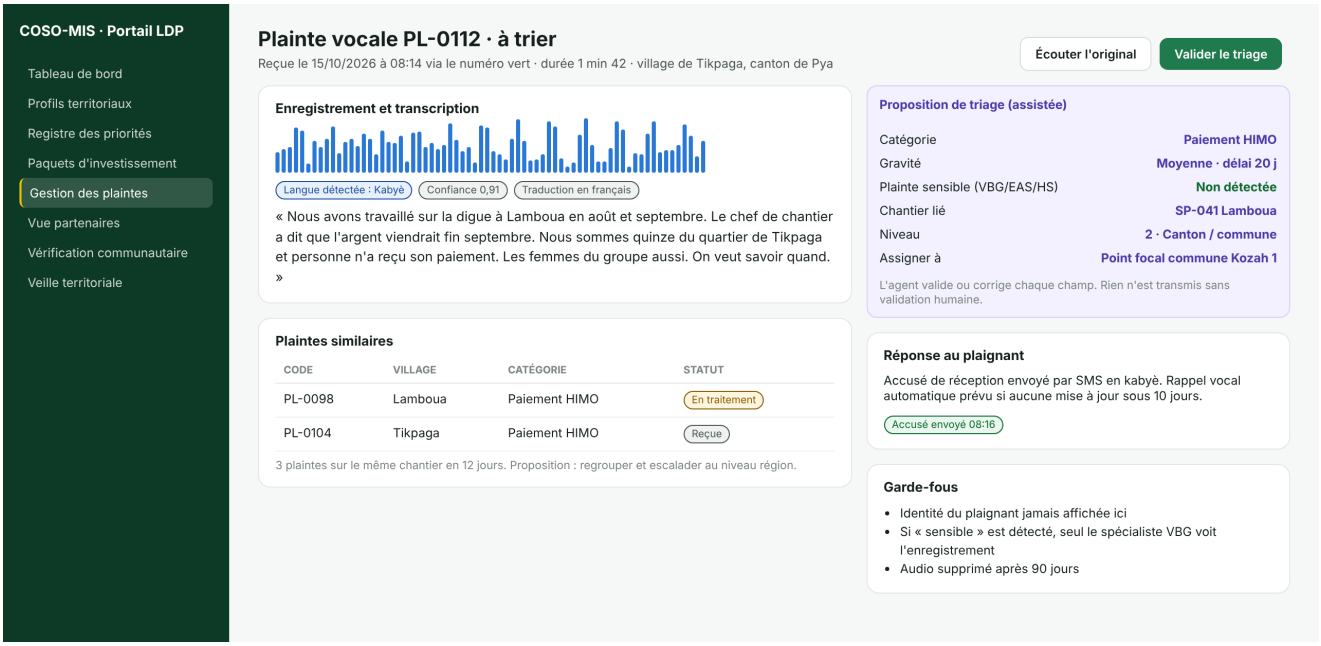
4. Complaints by voice, triaged in minutes

Today. Complaints arrive through boxes, committees and the toll-free line, are written up in French by an agent, and wait for someone to categorise, assign and acknowledge them. Nuance is lost in the rewrite; sensitive cases depend on the agent recognising them.

The idea. A complainant speaks in their language. The recording is transcribed and translated, and the system proposes a category, a severity, the linked worksite, the level and the assignee. It also flags similar complaints on the same site and screens for sensitive content, which it routes only to the specialist. An agent validates or corrects every field; nothing is sent without a human decision. An acknowledgement goes back by SMS in the complainant's language.

What it changes. Time from complaint to assignment drops from days to minutes. Patterns (three payment complaints on one site in twelve days) surface automatically. The complainant hears back the same day.

What it takes. Speech recognition for the three main local languages is the uncertain part; it must be tested on real recordings before any promise is made. A written data-protection decision on where recordings are processed and for how long they are kept.



Triage screen: recording, transcription, the assisted proposal on the right, and the guardrails that apply.

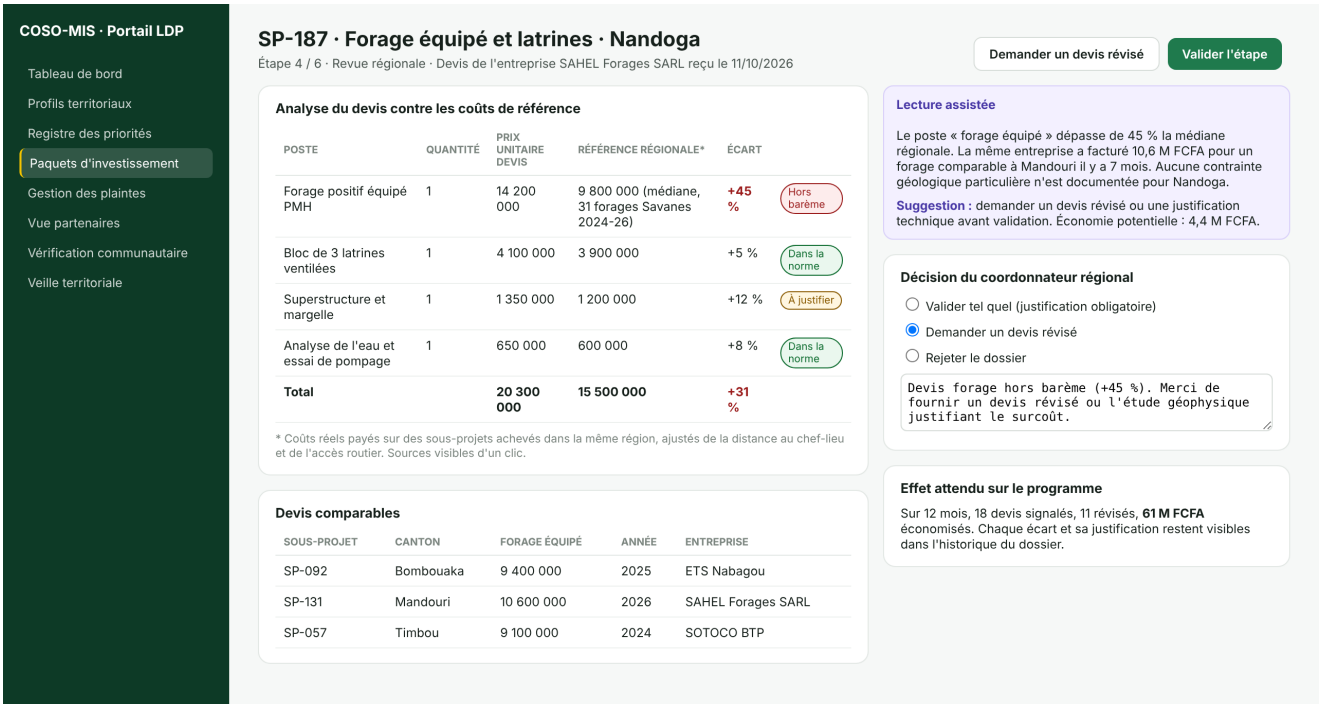
5. Every quote checked against what we actually paid

Today. A regional coordinator reviewing a quote relies on memory and a price schedule that is often out of date. Over-pricing is caught when someone happens to remember a comparable job.

The idea. The portal already stores every completed sub-project with its real costs. Each new quote is compared, line by line, with the median cost of similar works in the same region, adjusted for distance and road access. Outliers are flagged with the comparable quotes next to them, and the reviewer records a decision: validate with justification, request a revised quote, or reject. Every flag and decision stays in the dossier history.

What it changes. Price discipline without a new procedure. Savings are measurable and attributable. The history becomes evidence for audits and for the next price schedule.

What it takes. Clean unit-cost data from completed sub-projects, which the portal structure already supports. Low effort, fast payback.



A quote with one line 45 percent above the regional reference, comparable quotes, and the reviewer's decision recorded in the dossier.

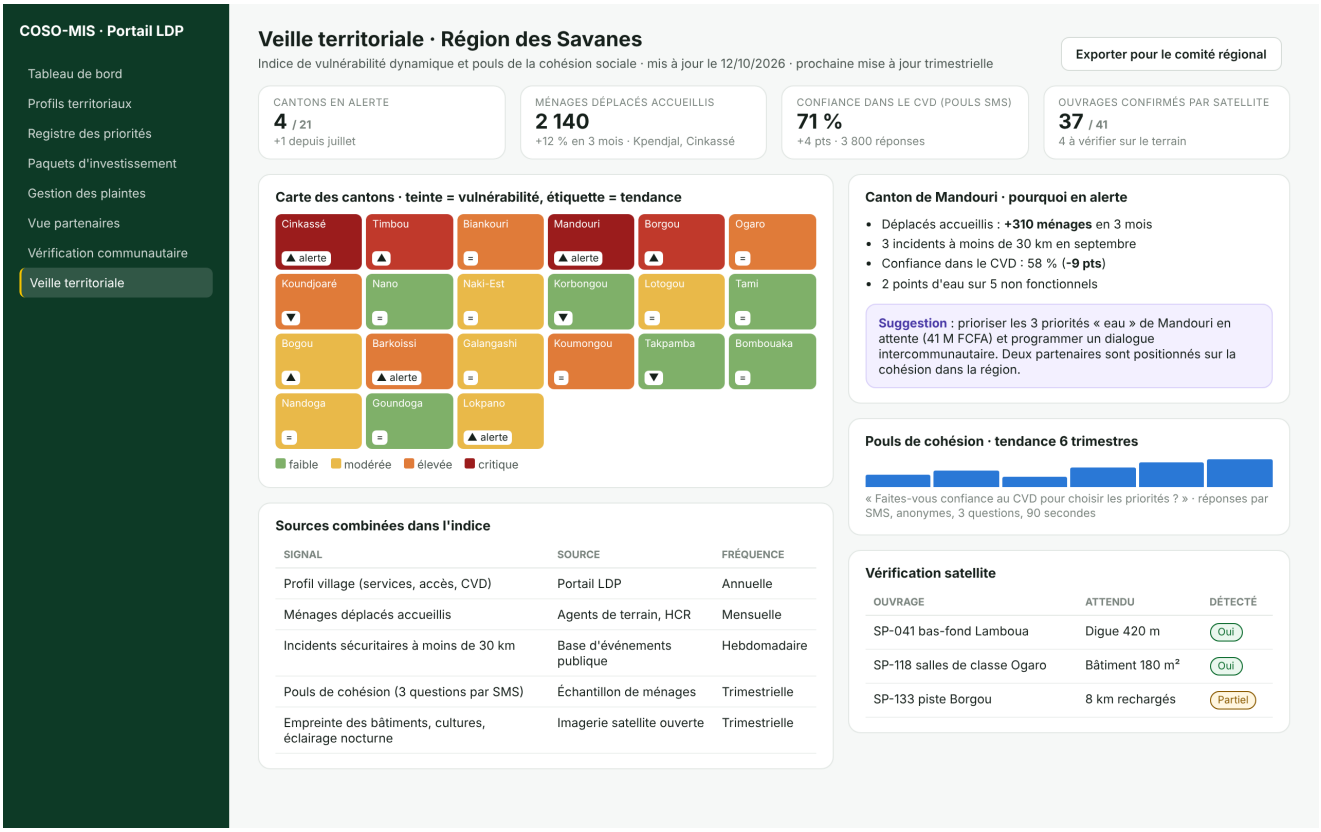
6. Vulnerability that updates itself

Today. The vulnerability index comes from a village survey that is redone every few years. In the Savanes, the situation changes in months: displaced households arrive, security incidents move, water points fail.

The idea. A territorial watch that refreshes the index every quarter by combining what we already collect (village profiles, displaced households reported by field agents) with public sources (security incident databases, open satellite imagery for buildings, crops and night lights) and a three-question SMS pulse on social cohesion sent to a sample of households. Satellite imagery also confirms that built works exist where the portal says they do.

What it changes. Cantons in deterioration are visible a quarter earlier. COSO is a social-cohesion project; a cohesion trend per canton is the indicator nobody else can show. Regional committees get an agenda, not a map.

What it takes. The most ambitious idea here. Needs a data partner for imagery and a survey protocol for the SMS pulse. Start with the two signals we control (displaced households, pulse) and add the others.



Regional watch: canton tiles coloured by vulnerability with trend labels, why a canton is in alert, the cohesion pulse, and satellite confirmation of works.

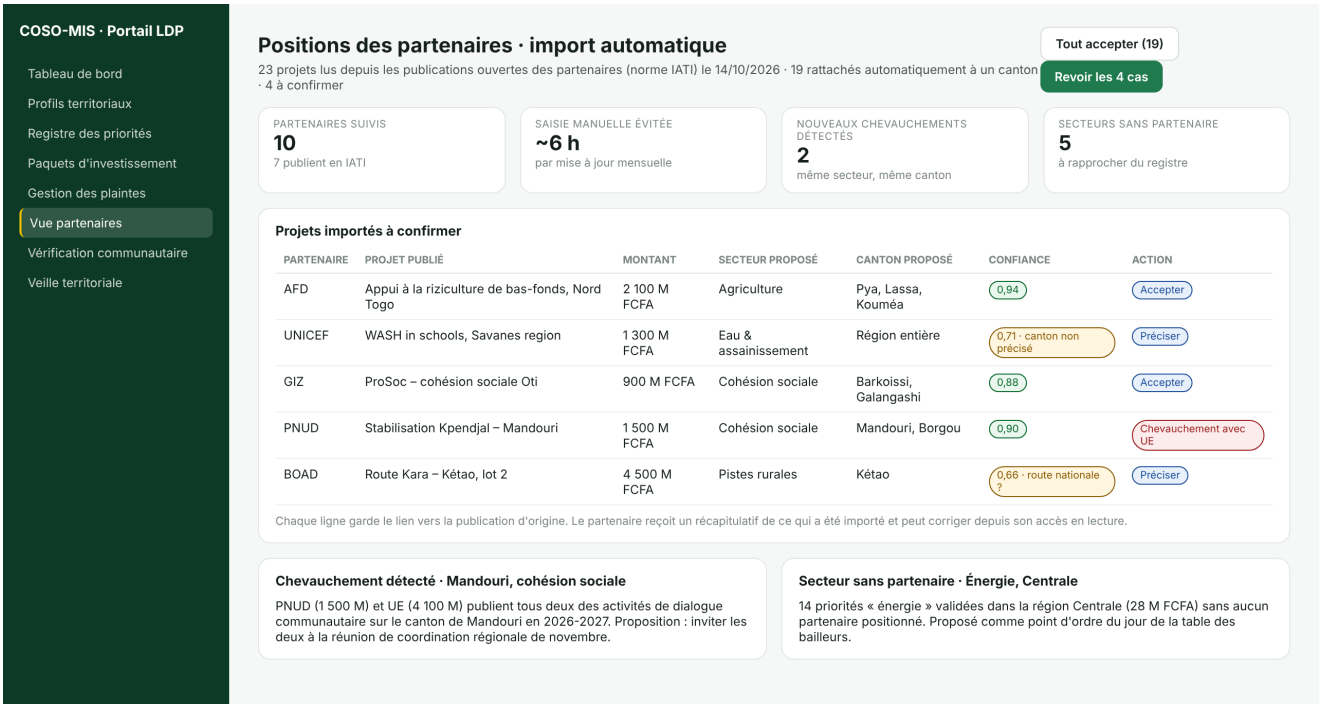
7. Partner positions pulled, not typed

Today. The partner matrix is filled by hand from partner reports and meetings. It is out of date the week after it is updated, and nobody enjoys maintaining it.

The idea. Most partners already publish their projects in an open international format. The portal reads those publications, proposes a sector and a canton for each project, and asks a coordinator to confirm the uncertain ones. Overlaps (two partners, same sector, same canton) and gaps (validated priorities with no partner) are raised automatically as agenda items for the coordination meeting.

What it changes. The matrix becomes trustworthy, and partner coordination gets a factual basis. Hours of data entry per month disappear.

What it takes. Low effort. Some partners publish with little geographic detail; the confirmation step handles that.



Imported partner projects awaiting confirmation, with an overlap and a gap already turned into coordination items.

Also in the pipeline: the assistant that lets partners ask questions of the portal data in plain language. Its concept note is already in the planning documents and is not repeated here.

How we would prove it: a six-month pilot

Ideas 1 to 4 form one loop and are piloted together; ideas 5 and 7 are cheap and can start in parallel; idea 6 starts with its two internal signals.

Scope	20 villages in two cantons, one in Savanes and one in Kara, with at least 12 sub-projects under execution
Duration	6 months, with a mid-point review at month 3
Metric 1	Share of surveyed villagers who can state the status of their village's first priority (baseline vs month 6)
Metric 2	Days from milestone completion to contractor payment
Metric 3	Days from complaint to first response, and share of complainants who hear back within 48 hours
Bonus	FCFA saved on revised quotes; hours of data entry saved on the partner matrix

Those three numbers, with a baseline, are the award application. Everything else is supporting material.

The award path

- Choose the award by its jury: UN Public Service Awards and the World Summit Awards reward citizen-facing public services; the Digital Public Goods registry is a credential every jury recognises; the World Bank's own recognitions reward replicability across operations.
- The regional story matters: COSO covers the northern regions of four countries. One open-source portal configured per country is a stronger submission than a Togo tool.
- Submit evidence, not screenshots: baseline versus pilot numbers, three villager quotes, one over-priced quote caught, one complaint resolved through the voice channel.
- The Togo team presents it. Country ownership is scored.

Decisions we need

Decision	Owner	Why it blocks
Can payment figures be public per worksite?	UCP	Idea 1 and the signboard
Can the disbursement procedure require committee confirmation per milestone?	UCP financial management, World Bank task team	Idea 3
Where are voice recordings processed and how long are they kept?	UCP safeguards, data protection authority	Idea 4
Short code and toll-free line with the operators	UCP, regulator	Idea 2
Pilot cantons and the team on the ground	Regional coordinators	Start date

Trade-offs we accept

- Publishing status invites scrutiny of delays. We accept that; it is the mechanism.
- Committee confirmation adds a step before payment. We accept a few days in exchange for verified progress and a measurable payment delay.
- Speech recognition in local languages may not be good enough at first. We pilot it on one complaint category, with a human always in the loop, and drop it if accuracy is not there.